

PCS-302 : Data Structures Lab

Boolean Matrix | Row with Maximum Number of 1's (Linear Time)

Problem Statement

Given a Boolean matrix (containing only 0 and 1) of size $m \times n$, where each row is sorted in increasing order, design an algorithm and write a program to find which row has the maximum number of 1's. The solution must run in linear time.

Example

Boolean matrix (4x5), each row sorted increasing (0's then 1's):

```
Row 0:  0  0  0  1  1      (2 ones)
Row 1:  0  1  1  1  1      (4 ones)
Row 2:  0  0  1  1  1      (3 ones)
Row 3:  0  0  0  0  1      (1 one)
```

Row with maximum 1's --> Row 1

Algorithm (Staircase Search)

1. `col = n - 1, maxRow = -1`
2. For `row = 0` to `m - 1`:
 While `col >= 0 AND mat[row][col] == 1`:
 `col = col - 1`
 `maxRow = row` // this row beats the previous best
3. Return `maxRow`

Why linear: the `col` pointer only ever moves left and is never reset, so across all rows it moves at most n times in total. Combined with m rows, total work = $O(m + n)$.

C Program

```
#include <stdio.h>
#define M 4
#define N 5

int main() {
    int mat[M][N] = {
        {0, 0, 0, 1, 1},
        {0, 1, 1, 1, 1},
        {0, 0, 1, 1, 1},
        {0, 0, 0, 0, 1}
    };

    int row, col;
    int maxRow = -1;       // row with maximum 1's so far
    col = N - 1;          // start at the last column
    for (row = 0; row < M; row++) {
```

```
        for ( ; col >= 0 && mat[row][col] == 1; col--) {
            maxRow = row;    // this row has more 1's than the previous best
        }

    if (maxRow == -1)
        printf("No row contains a 1.\n");
    else
        printf("Row %d has the maximum number of 1's.\n", maxRow);

    return 0;
}
```